Guidance

How Indian degrees are recognised in EU Member States

What “recognition” means for study, for a job and for a regulated profession, what an ENIC-NARIC statement of comparability gives you, and the process, timelines and Indian-specific pitfalls.

AUDIENCE
Candidate, Student, Researcher, Employer, Institution

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The three different things people mean by “recognition”

01

You want to study further

You’re applying for a master’s or PhD. In many cases, the university or admissions service assesses your Indian qualification as part of the admission process, so you may not need a separate national recognition document. Requirements vary by country and institution, so check the admissions office before applying.

02

You want a job

Software engineer, data analyst and many IT-ITeS roles are generally unregulated professions, although this varies by country and occupation. Professional qualification recognition is normally not required simply to practise an unregulated profession. However, an employer, immigration authority or visa route may still require evidence that your qualification is recognised or comparable.

03

You want to practise a regulated profession

Doctors, nurses, dentists, pharmacists, architects and veterinarians are regulated in the EU under specific professional rules. Lawyers, teachers and some engineering professions may also be regulated, depending on the Member State and the specific role. Where a profession is regulated, you normally need professional recognition and/or registration with the relevant competent authority before you can practise.

What ENIC-NARIC actually gives you

Each country's centre issues a document usually called a **statement of comparability**. In plain terms it says: *"This Indian qualification sits at approximately this level in our national system."*

For example, it might conclude your Indian master's is comparable to a French Master (Bac+5, EQF level 7), or your B.E. is comparable to a German Bachelor.

What it does not do:

- It does not make your degree "equal" in law. It's an expert opinion, not a court ruling.
- It does not oblige any university to admit you.
- It does not oblige any employer to hire you.
- It does not license you to practise a regulated profession.
- The document generally focuses on the level and status of the qualification rather than converting individual grades or assessing your language proficiency. The exact content varies by country..

The main centres you'll deal with

Country	Centre	Document
Germany	ZAB (Zentralstelle für ausländisches Bildungswesen)	Zeugnisbewertung / Statement of Comparability
France	ENIC-NARIC France (France Éducation International)	Attestation de comparabilité
Netherlands	Nuffic, via the IDW portal	Diplomawaardering / credential evaluation
Ireland	NARIC Ireland (part of QQI)	Comparability statement

Country	Centre	Document
Italy	CIMEA, or a Dichiarazione di Valore from the Italian embassy in India	Statement of comparability / Declaration of Value

> The full list of official centres for all countries is at **enic-naric.net**. Use it. There is a large industry of private “NARIC certificate” agencies that charge multiples of the official fee for the same thing.

A note on the legal background

Europe’s recognition rules come from the **Lisbon Recognition Convention (1997)**. Its core principle is generous: a foreign qualification should be recognised at the same level as a domestic one *unless there is a substantial difference* and the burden is on the evaluating country to prove the difference exists, not on you to prove it doesn’t.

India is not a party to the Lisbon Recognition Convention or the UNESCO Global Convention on the Recognition of Qualifications concerning Higher Education. This means that recognition of an Indian qualification in an EU Member State is primarily governed by the destination country’s national rules and procedures rather than by treaty-based recognition rights under those conventions.

The process, step by step

0. **Step 0 – Check whether you need it**

   Genuinely free options first:

   - Ireland publishes comparability statements for common qualifications in a free public database. If your Indian degree is already listed, you download it and you’re done. Only unlisted qualifications need a query.
   - Germany’s anabin database lets you check the status of your institution and, in some cases, your qualification. An H+ classification is an important indication that the institution is recognised, but the relevant university, employer or authority may still require additional evidence.

1. **Step 1 – Gather your documents**

   Typically: degree certificate, consolidated marksheets or transcripts for every year, and your passport. Sometimes the syllabus or course structure. Provisional certificates are often rejected, get the final degree.

Two things quietly sink applications: **name mismatches** across your documents, and degrees from institutions or programmes that were not appropriately recognised/approved by the competent Indian authorities at the time of study.

2. **Step 2 – Get an apostille**

   Where the destination country is a party to the Hague Apostille Convention and accepts the apostilled document for the intended purpose, further embassy legalisation is generally not required.

   The chain usually runs: university → state HRD department or SDM → MEA. The MEA's own fee is nominal, but MEA only accepts submissions through its outsourced agencies, and state-level verification is where the delay lives. The **eSanad** portal now handles this digitally for participating universities, which is considerably faster.

   > **An apostille does not certify the academic equivalence or quality of the degree.**

3. **Step 3 – Translate, if needed**

   Translation requirements vary by country, authority and purpose. Germany, France, Italy and some other countries may require certified or sworn translations, while the Netherlands generally accepts documents in Dutch, English, German or French without translation.

4. **Step 4 – Apply and wait**

   Most major recognition services now offer online application or document-submission systems, but the exact process differs between countries and authorities.

How long it takes, and what it costs

Processing times vary by country and by the type of application:

Country	Service	Processing time
Germany	ZAB, regular Statement of Comparability	approximately three months once the application is complete and the full fee has been received
Germany	ZAB, Fast-Track Procedure for Skilled Workers	approximately two months
Germany	ZAB, applications connected with an EU Blue Card	approximately two weeks

Country	Service	Processing time
France	ENIC-NARIC France	approximately four months on average; cases can take up to six months
Netherlands	Credential evaluation through IDW	up to four months
Ireland	QQI/NARIC Ireland, unlisted qualification	several weeks

Indian-specific things that trip people up

Three-year vs four-year bachelor's. Do not assume that a three-year Indian bachelor's is automatically equivalent to a European bachelor's. Requirements vary by country, institution and programme. A three-year Indian degree may be sufficient for some forms of further study or employment, while a particular master's programme may require a four-year degree, a specified number of credits, particular subjects or a particular level of learning outcomes. India's four-year undergraduate programmes may be advantageous for some recognition or admission purposes, but they should not be described as automatically equivalent to a European four-year degree.

Your institution's recognition status is one of the most important checks. The evaluating authority may also assess the qualification itself, the programme, duration and mode of study, and other characteristics.

Affiliated colleges. If an affiliated college delivered the programme but the degree was formally awarded by the university, the university is normally the awarding institution and should be identified as such. Include the affiliated college as the place of study where the application asks for it.

Germany has an extra step for students. Indian applicants to German universities need an APS certificate from the Academic Evaluation Centre at the German Embassy in New Delhi, verifying your documents. This is separate from ZAB and separate from admission. Build it into your timeline.

Grades. A statement of comparability generally does not convert your percentage into a university admission grade. Universities and admissions services may apply their own grade-conversion methodology; in Germany, the modified Bavarian formula is commonly used, but the exact admissions rules are institution- and programme-specific.